C1 Listening

# News reports: main idea and detail

Separate the main story from supporting detail and background in a short radio news item.

News reports follow a pattern: the main point comes first, then details, quotes and background. Knowing this structure helps you decide what to note and what to let go.

| Part | What it contains | Typical signals |
|---|---|---|
| Headline sentence | Who did what, the core change | The first sentence |
| Details | Numbers, places, dates | *The plan includes… From next month…* |
| Reaction | What people say about it | *said, welcomed, criticised* |
| Background | Why it is happening now | *The move follows… Last year…* |

## Listen

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The Ministry of Education has announced that coding will become a compulsory subject in all secondary schools from next September. Students will have two lessons a week, and around five hundred new teachers will be trained over the summer. The teachers' association welcomed the decision but warned that many schools still lack reliable internet access. The move follows a report last year showing that fewer than one in five graduates had basic programming skills, a figure the ministry described as a serious concern for the economy.

**Summarise in ten words.** After listening, try to state the main idea in ten words or fewer. If you can, you have understood the story.

**Common mistake.** Treating the background or a reaction as the main point. The internet problem is important, but it is a reaction, not the news itself.

# Practice

1. Summarise the main point in no more than ten words.
2. Give two details about how the plan will work.
3. How did the teachers' association react?
4. What background reason is given for the change?
5. Which of these is background, not the main news? (a) coding becomes compulsory (b) fewer than one in five graduates could program

▼ **Show answers**

1. For example: Coding becomes compulsory in secondary schools from September.
2. Two lessons a week; about 500 new teachers trained over the summer.
3. It welcomed the decision but warned that many schools lack reliable internet.
4. A report last year found fewer than one in five graduates had basic programming skills.
5. (b)